CCC-G-101c
JANUARY 15, 1957
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. CCC-G-101b
November 4, 1943

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

GAUZE, ABSORBENT

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. — This specification covers absorbent gauze to be used for surgical dressings.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.*—Absorbent gauze shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type	*Commercial designation*
Type I	44-36
Type II	32-28
Type III	28-24
Type IV	24-20
Type V	22-18
Type VI	20-16
Type VII	20-12

1.2.2 *Classes.*—Absorbent gauze shall be of the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1.—Nonsterile.
Class 2.—Sterile.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

CCC–T–191—Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

JAN–P–108—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid (Military Type).

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publication. — The following document forms a part of this specification.

402171/57/No. 214

FSC Class 6510

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Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

U. S. Pharmacopoeial Convention Publication:

Pharmacopoeia of the United States.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.—The gauze shall be made from thoroughly clean cotton, free from waste. The gauze shall be free from loading matter and shall be substantially free from particles other than cotton.

3.2 Color.—Unless otherwise specified, the gauze shall not contain any added coloring matter. If a camouflage color is specified, the gauze shall be brown, dyed to the acceptable color standard for each type with Pontamine Brown B.T. concentrate, or an equivalent, approved by the purchasing activity (see 6.2).

3.3 United States Pharmacopoeia requirements. — The gauze shall comply with all United States Pharmacopoeia (U.S.P.) requirements for the type and class specified. If dyed gauze is specified (see 3.2), the dyed gauze shall comply with the U.S.P. requirements except the following: Water extract; acid or alkali, residue on ignition, and uncombined dyes.

3.4 Breaking strength.—When tested as described in 4.3.1, the breaking strength of type I gauze shall be not less than 20 pounds in the warp direction and not less than 9 pounds in filling direction. Class 2 gauze shall be sterilized in an autoclave at 15 pounds pressure for 30 minutes before being tested.

3.5 Sterilization.—The sterilization of class 2 gauze shall be accomplished by steam, and the gauze shall be thoroughly dried after sterilization. Chemical sterilization is not permissible.

3.6 Certificate of sterility.—When specified for class 2 gauze, a certificate of sterility, listing all lot or control numbers, stating that samples from each sterilizer charge have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted by the contractor to the procuring activity.

3.7 Workmanship. — The gauze shall be free from defects which affect its appearance or which may affect its serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Unless otherwise specified, samples shall be submitted in accordance with instructions furnished by the procuring activity (see 6.2). In addition, sampling procedures shall be conducted in accordance with the procedures set forth in Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.2 Inspection.—Inspection may be made throughout the entire process of manufacture. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of construction or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance. Final inspection of the finished article shall be made either at point of production or point of delivery, as specified (see 6.2). In case of factory inspection, every facility shall be afforded inspectors, by the manufacturer, for the prosecution of their work. Samples shall be inspected for material, workmanship, dimensions, and packaging, packing, and marking in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

4.2.1 *Classification of defects.*

Categories and defects

Major	AQL 2.00 percent
101.	Loading.
102.	Coloring matter and reaction.
103.	Torn selvedges.
104.	Thin stripes (in excess of 1 inch).
105.	Thick stripes (in excess of ½ inch).
106.	Holes (1 inch or greater).
107.	Seams.
108.	Bad odor.

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Minor AQL 10.00 percent

201. Loose threads.
202. Dirty bunch (slub).
203. Broken yarn.
204. Hangers.
205. Stains and spots other than seed fragments or cotton neps.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Breaking strength.* — Breaking strength of the gauze shall be determined as described in Federal specification CCC–T–191, method 5100, grab method, except that the distance between the jaws of the testing machine shall be 1½ inches apart at the start of the test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For definitions and levels, see 6.1).

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 *Unit of issue.*

5.1.1.1 *Stock No. 6510-202-1000.* — Five yards of gauze, 36 inches wide, constitute one unit.

5.1.1.2 *Stock No. 6510-202-2000.*—Twenty-five yards of gauze, 36 inches wide, constitute one unit.

5.1.1.3 *Stock No. 6510-202-3000.* — One hundred yards of gauze, 36 inches wide, constitute one unit.

5.1.2 *Quantities.*—Packaging and packing quantities shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I.—*Packaging and packing quantities*

Stock number	Unit pack	Intermediate pack	Shipping container
	Unit	*Units*	*Units*
6510–202–1000	1	12	144
6510–202–2000	1	12	48
6510–202–3000	1	6	12

5.1.2.1 *Packing variation permitted.* — If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 *Level A.*

5.1.3.1 *Unit package.*

5.1.3.1.1 *Folding.*

5.1.3.1.1.1 *Stock No. 6510-202-1000.*—The gauze shall be furnished in one piece, a continuous tight roll, approximately four and one half inches wide, evenly folded to eight ply width-wise.

5.1.3.1.1.2 *Stock No. 6510-202-2000.*—The gauze shall be furnished in a tight roll, approximately four and one half inches wide, evenly folded to eight ply width-wise, in not more than two pieces. No piece shall be less than ten yards in length.

5.1.3.1.1.3 *Stock No. 6510-202-3000.*—The gauze shall be furnished in not more than two pieces; no piece shall be less than ten yards in length. The gauze shall be evenly folded in continuous flat folds 36 inches square, and folded twice to form a flat bolt 36 inches by 12 inches, with folded edges of flat folds at ends of bolt. Each bolt shall be tumbled once. The finished size of the unit shall be approximately 18 inches by 12 inches.

5.1.3.1.2 *Bag.*—Each folded unit shall be packaged in a bag fabricated from virgin polyethylene seamless tubing having an average wall thickness of 0.004 inch, with no wall thickness at any point below 0.00325-inch. Excess air shall be expelled or evacuated and closure effected by heat sealing.

5.1.3.2 *Intermediate package.*—The number of unit packages specified in table I shall

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8.8 United States Pharmacopoeia requires ... quality, workmanship of materials which may

be packaged in a weatherproof fiberboard box constructed in accordance with Military Specification JAN–P–108, compliance symbol W6c or W6s, except that the manufacturers' joint shall be effected by the application of water-resistant tape, or by gluing integral lap to outer face of end or side panel using water-resistant adhesive, in lieu of metal stitches. Closure shall be effected by gluing of flaps or application of water-resistant gummed tape 2 inches wide applied over top and bottom center lengthwise seam extending 2 inches onto each end panel.

5.1.4 *Level C.*—Each unit shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used for the purpose, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the end product for its intended purpose within the continental limits of the United States of America.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Exterior container.* — The number of units specified in table I shall be overpacked in an exterior container constructed in accordance with Military Specification JAN–P–108, compliance symbol V3c or V3s. Closure shall comply with appendix thereto.

5.2.1.2 *Strapping.* — Strapping (when required) shall be in accordance with appendix to box specification.

NOTE.—Strapping will not be required for shipment forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 *Level C.* — The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Unit packages.*—Each unit package shall be marked with stock number, item identification, unit, quantity, name of contractor, and information required by the Pharmacopoeia of the United States for labeling of absorbent gauze.

5.3.2 *Intermediate carton and shipping container.*—Each intermediate carton and each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129. Service color marking and symbol are not required on containers for level A packs when addressed to domestic establishments, for the Medical Services of the Armed Forces.

6. NOTES

6.1 Federal Standard 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.

6.2 **Ordering data.** — Procurements documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type and class required (see 1.2).
(*c*) Width and yardage required.
(*d*) Color required (see 3.2).
(*e*) Whether certificates of sterility are required (see 3.6).
(*f*) Sampling required (see 4.1).
(*g*) Inspection required (see 4.2).
(*h*) Place of final inspection (see 4.2).
(*i*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Armed Services Medical Stock List:

6510–202–1000 Gauze, Absorbent, 36 inches by 5 yards
6510–202–2000 Gauze, Absorbent, 36 inches by 25 yards
6510–202–3000 Gauze, Absorbent, 36 inches by 100 yards

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6.4 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.5 Transportation description.—Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Bandages, cheesecloth, cotton
Carload minimum weight, any quantity
Open mesh fabrics, cotton, not otherwise indexed, gauze
Truckload minimum weight, any quantity.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—M Q
Navy—Md
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

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